Preface

This edition has been revamped and rewritten after getting the tremendous response from the academicians, students, young scholars and teaching faculties all over India since the book was published in 2009. Current international scenario has compelled us to look afresh at the events happening all around the globe. The global recession that set in 2008 send shock waves and international political economy witnessed a massive depression. This depression touched the Eurozone too and the Euro debt crisis is known to all. Moreover, turbulence in Syria, Iraq and Afghanistan and the rise of new terror axis has complicated the situation in these countries. The deteriorating political conditions in these countries called for international action, including air strikes that have forced thousands to leave their countries and voyage into other countries, especially, Europe. The massive influx of 'boat people' has given rise to an unprecedented humanitarian crisis in Europe. Another development in international political economy is the falling crude price. The world is grappling in coming to terms with these crises amongst many. The book cannot disregard such developments. Therefore, a chapter (Chapter 20) Migration and Refugees and (Chapter 22) on **Current Concerns in International Relations: India and the World** has been added to stay in tune with the changes in international relations.

The book starts with an introduction to the discipline of International Relations and Chapters 1–5 deal with the theoretical aspects of International Relations. These chapters primarily focus on the evolution, nature and scope of International Relations, different approaches to the study of International Relations, detailed discussion on international system and states and non-state actors, national power, national interest, balance of power and foreign policy and its determinants and various techniques. Chapters 6–9 deal with the major world events and patterns of international relations that emerged in the post-Second World War era. Chapter 10 deals with regionalism in international relations and major regional organizations of the world and their role in world politics. Chapter 11